

d.BOBO

Think-Build System

End of Cycle 2 Report

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1. Report Outline

This report documents the completion of Cycle 2: finalization of the handoff system based on Joel's production testing, refinement of GPT 1's prompt to eliminate framework confusion and hallucination, and establishment of the design framework for GPT 2 (Custom) to be built in Cycle 3.

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2. System Metaphor / Cycle Intent

2.1 System Metaphor

The d.BOBO Think-Build System remains grounded in the pilot's six-pack metaphor: a minimal, essential set of business instruments (Asili, Mission, Vision, Custom, SIPOC, Funnel) that enable founders to launch decisively without a 500-page business plan. The system is organized into two diamonds (Think and Build) with four GPTs that move founders sequentially through the framework. Each GPT stays in its lane — no overlap, no improvisation.

2.2 Cycle 2 Intent

Cycle 2 had three primary objectives:

1. Finalize the handoff system: Complete the Google Apps Script endpoint integration, resolve the 302 redirect issue, and confirm that email notifications and Google Sheets logging work reliably in production. This was achieved. Joel tested the system end-to-end and confirmed it works perfectly.
2. Refine GPT 1 based on production testing: Joel conducted a full walkthrough with a fake business scenario and identified critical issues where the GPT drifted into mainstream startup methodology (validation, prototyping, landing pages) and confused the framework structure (mixing Custom, SIPOC, and Build stages). The prompt was updated with strict guardrails and anti-hallucination instructions.
3. Establish the design framework for GPT 2: Document the correct scope of Custom (customer identification, needs/answers chart, Custom Statement only — no SIPOC, no validation, no prototyping), write preliminary prompt logic, and prepare handoff parameters so GPT 2 can receive context from GPT 1.

All three objectives were completed. The handoff system is production-ready. GPT 1 now has a hard stop at the checkpoint and will not continue past Vision. The framework for GPT 2 is documented and ready for implementation in Cycle 3.

2.3 Cycle 3 Intent

Cycle 3 will focus on building GPT 2 (Custom) and GPT 3 (SIPOC), implementing the progress indicator system (text-based in each GPT's welcome message, with exploration of website embedding for a visual stepper), and working with Joel to test the full Think → Custom → SIPOC flow with real founders.

3. User Stories

User stories remain unchanged from Cycle 1. The completion status has been updated to reflect Cycle 2 work. Stories marked with ✓ are complete. Stories marked with △ have been revised or had their scope clarified. Stories marked with → are planned for future cycles.

GPT 1 — Think: Asili, Mission & Vision (Complete)

ID	Status	User Story
US-01	✓	As a founder, I want to tell the story of where my business idea came from so that I can ground my business in something real and true (Asili).
US-02	✓	As a founder, I want to identify who is on my team — advisors, helpers, role players — so that I know I am not building alone.
US-03	✓	As a founder, I want to find an African proverb that captures my Asili so that I have a cultural anchor for my brand.
US-04	✓	As a founder, I want to identify an image, metaphor, or analogy that represents my business visually so that I have a foundation for logos and taglines.
US-05	✓	As a founder, I want to write a mission statement that clearly states what I do and for whom, so that I can use it everywhere.
US-06	✓	As a founder, I want to write a vision statement with a real timeframe (months or years) and a measurable outcome, so that I know what winning looks like.

GPT 2 — Custom (Cycle 3)

ID	Status	User Story
US-07	→	As a founder, I want to identify my best customer and understand what they actually need, so that I am not guessing.
US-08	→	As a founder, I want to write a Custom Statement ("I help ___ to ___ by ___") so that I have a script for pitches, grants, and cold conversations.
US-09	→	As a founder, I want to build a needs-and-answers chart so that I can map my offerings directly to customer pain.

GPT 3 — SIPOC (Cycle 3)

ID	Status	User Story
US-10	→	As a founder, I want to map my process from supplier to customer so that I can see how my business actually works end to end.
US-11	→	As a founder, I want to understand my Cost of Quality and Cost of Poor Quality so that I know where I am losing time and money.

US-1 2	→	As a founder, I want to sketch my shop — whether home-based, brick-and-mortar, or online — so that I can plan my physical and digital workspace.
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GPT 4 — Serve Funnel & Launch (Future)

ID	Status	User Story
US-1 3	→	As a founder, I want to build a sales funnel that shows how customers move from unaware to buying, so that I have a path to revenue.
US-1 4	→	As a founder, I want to understand inbound vs. outbound marketing and which channels fit my business, so that I am not throwing spaghetti at the wall.
US-1 5	→	As a founder, I want to reach a launch checklist at the end so that I know exactly what needs to happen before I open.

Cross-GPT Stories (Handoff & Progress Tracking)

ID	Status	User Story
US-1 6	✓	As a founder, I want the option to connect with Joel at a checkpoint so that I can get personalized coaching on a tough spot.
US-1 7	✓	As Joel, I want to receive a clean summary of a user's progress and conversation so that I can prepare for a call without reading the full thread.
US-1 8	→	As a founder, I want to pick up where I left off if I return to a GPT later, so that my progress is not lost.
US-1 9	⚠	As a founder, I want to see where I am in the overall framework (Think → Custom → SIPOC → Funnel) so that I understand the commitment and can pace myself.

4. Design Documentation

4.1 GPT 1 Refinements

Based on Joel's production testing, GPT 1's prompt was updated with the following critical changes:

Change	Rationale
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Hard stop at checkpoint	GPT 1 now refuses to continue past Stage 8 (Vision + Checkpoint). If the founder asks what's next, it says: 'That's GPT 2 — d.BOBO Custom. Here's the link.' and stops. No improvisation.
Framework reminder block	Added explicit scope declaration at top of prompt: 'You are GPT 1 of 4. Your scope: Think diamond only (Asili, Mission, Vision). Do NOT touch: Custom, SIPOC, Funnel, validation, prototyping, landing pages.'
Anti-hallucination guard	Added instruction: 'If the founder asks about anything outside your scope, do not try to help. Say: That lives in a different GPT. Redirect them to the next GPT link.'
Clearer handoff language	Updated checkpoint offer to be more explicit: 'Before moving to GPT 2, would you like to loop Joel in?' instead of vague 'next step' language.

4.2 GPT 2 Framework (Custom)

The design framework for GPT 2 was established based on Joel's feedback and the framework slides. GPT 2's scope is strictly limited to the Custom stage of the Think diamond. It does NOT touch SIPOC, validation, prototyping, or marketing.

GPT 2 Conversation Flow (Preliminary):

Stage	Description
0. Welcome + Context	Receive handoff from GPT 1 (Asili, Mission, Vision). Greet the founder and frame Custom: 'Now we identify your best customer and the exact problem you solve for them.'
1. Customer Identification	Ask: Who would you really like to give 1000 hours of service to? Who is your starting customer? Guide them to be specific, not broad.
2. Customer Classification	Help them classify by demographics, psychographics, behavior. Keep it simple — no jargon. Natural categories only.
3. Needs Discovery	Build the needs-and-answers chart. Ask: If you were showing deep curiosity to this customer, what would they tell you they need? Use verbs, not nouns.
4. Answers Mapping	For each need, ask: How do you answer that? What do you provide? Draft answers together using action verbs.
5. Custom Statement	Use the template: 'I help [who] to [what] by [how].' Iterate until tight. Let them write mild, medium, spicy versions.

6. Checkpoint	Summarize all Custom outputs (customer profile, needs/answers chart, Custom Statement). Offer handoff to Joel. Point to GPT 3 (SIPOC) for next step.
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4.3 Critical Guardrails for GPT 2

The following instructions will be embedded in GPT 2's prompt to prevent the hallucination issues Joel encountered:

1. DO NOT suggest validation, soft launches, prototyping, or testing the idea. The founder's idea is valid if they have reached this stage. d.BOBO assumes the idea works — the job is to build the system that carries it.
2. DO NOT ask about landing pages, websites, or marketing channels. That is GPT 4 (Serve Funnel). Stay in your lane.
3. DO NOT start SIPOC. Do not ask about suppliers, inputs, processes, outputs, or delivery channels. That is GPT 3. If the founder mentions SIPOC, say: 'That's the next stage — GPT 3. Let's finish Custom first.'
4. DO NOT mix mainstream startup methodology (Lean Startup, MVP thinking, 'validate first') into the conversation. d.BOBO is compression, not iteration. The framework is: Think → Build → Launch. No detours.

4.4 Progress Indicator Design

Joel requested a visual progress indicator showing where the founder is in the overall framework. ChatGPT's interface does not support custom UI elements, so three solutions were designed:

Solution	Implementation	Status
Text-based stepper in GPT welcome	Each GPT's welcome message includes: 'Your progress: ✓ Think → [Custom] → SIPOC → Funnel → Launch' with current stage highlighted.	Ready for implementation in Cycle 3
Website embedding with visual stepper	If the GPT system is embedded in Joel's website (e.g., via iframe or ChatGPT Enterprise API), a custom progress bar can be displayed above the chat interface.	Exploration planned for Cycle 3
Artifact-based progress tracker	Generate a visual progress diagram as an artifact (HTML/SVG) at the start of each GPT. Does not persist across sessions, but can be regenerated.	Low priority; text-based is sufficient

5. Lessons Learned

#	Lesson
1	LLMs will improvise if given the opportunity. GPT 1 tried to be helpful when Joel continued past the checkpoint, but it hallucinated framework structure and mixed in mainstream startup methodology. Hard stops are essential.
2	Framework reminder blocks at the top of each prompt are critical. Without them, the LLM does not know where it sits in the overall system and will drift into adjacent stages.
3	Anti-hallucination instructions must be explicit and repetitive. Saying 'Do NOT do X' once is not enough. The prompt must say it multiple times in different ways: 'Do NOT do X. If asked about X, redirect. X is not your job.'
4	Mainstream startup methodology (Lean Startup, MVP, validate-first thinking) is deeply embedded in LLM training data. The LLM will default to it unless explicitly instructed otherwise. d.BOBO's philosophy ('This already works. Now build the system.') must be stated clearly and repeatedly.
5	Joel's testing revealed that SIPOC is the most confusing stage for the LLM. It tried to start SIPOC in the middle of Custom and got the order wrong (started with Process instead of Supplier). GPT 3's prompt will need extra clarity on the correct sequence: Supplier → Input → Process → Output → Customer.
6	The tone and pacing of GPT 1 were effective. Joel described it as 'a little forceful and nudgy but good' until it started to wander. This confirms that the conversational approach (one question at a time, space for reflection) is working as intended.
7	Founders need to see the big picture. Joel's request for a progress indicator shows that founders want to understand the commitment upfront. The stepper helps them pace themselves and see that there is a clear end point (Launch).
8	The handoff system works perfectly in production. Joel confirmed that emails arrive reliably, the Google Sheet logs all data correctly, and the summary format is clear and useful for pre-call preparation.
9	Testing with real scenarios (even fake businesses) is invaluable. Joel's poster business walkthrough revealed issues that would not have been visible in abstract testing. Production testing with real founders should be prioritized in Cycle 3.
10	Each GPT needs its own distinct personality within the overall d.BOBO voice. GPT 1 is calm and grounding (Think diamond). GPT 2 will be curious and probing (Custom). GPT 3 will be systematic and operational (SIPOC). GPT 4 will be practical and action-oriented (Funnel + Launch).

6. Management Plan

6.1 Meeting Cadence

The team continued with the once-per-week meeting cadence established in Cycle 1. Meetings focused on reviewing Joel's testing feedback, diagnosing the hallucination issues, and designing the refinements for GPT 1 and the framework for GPT 2. Each meeting included a walkthrough of updated prompts and a discussion of technical constraints (e.g., progress indicator options within ChatGPT's interface).

6.2 Task Breakdown & Status

Task	Owner	Status	Notes
Review Joel's production testing feedback	Team	Complete	Identified framework confusion and hallucination
Diagnose GPT 1 hallucination issues	Team	Complete	LLM mixed Custom, SIPOC, and mainstream methodology
Add hard stop to GPT 1 at checkpoint	Team	Complete	GPT now refuses to continue past Vision
Add framework reminder block to GPT 1 prompt	Team	Complete	Explicit scope: Think diamond only
Add anti-hallucination guardrails to GPT 1	Team	Complete	Multiple instructions to prevent drift
Confirm handoff system works in production	Joel	Complete	Email and Sheet logging work perfectly
Document GPT 2 scope and guardrails	Team	Complete	Custom only — no SIPOC, no validation
Write preliminary GPT 2 conversation flow	Team	Complete	6-stage sequence documented
Design progress indicator solutions	Team	Complete	Text-based for Cycle 3, website for later
Test updated GPT 1 with hard stop	Joel	In Progress	Awaiting Joel's next test session
Build GPT 2 (Custom)	Team	Planned	Cycle 3 — first priority

Build GPT 3 (SIPOC)	Team	Planned	Cycle 3 — second priority
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7. Memoranda

7.1 Joel's Production Testing Feedback (Detailed)

Joel conducted a full walkthrough of GPT 1 with a fake business idea (historical Black posters). He reported that the Think diamond stages (Asili through Vision) worked well — the tone was calm and direct, the pacing was good, and the outputs were solid. However, when he continued past the checkpoint (instead of switching to GPT 2), the GPT started to hallucinate.

Issue 1: The GPT pushed him into validation steps (soft launch post, prototype testing) that are not in the d.BOBO framework. Joel had to correct it: 'd.BOBO doesn't ask Does this work? It assumes: This already works. Now build the system that carries it properly.'

Issue 2: The GPT tried to start SIPOC in the middle of Custom and got the order wrong. It asked about Process first instead of Supplier. Joel corrected it and the GPT acknowledged: 'Yes. That's the right correction. Supplier is every outside source that makes fulfillment possible.'

Issue 3: The GPT conflated Custom and SIPOC into one stage and incorrectly told Joel he had 'completed SIPOC' when he was actually still in Custom. When Joel asked 'Where are we in the framework?' the GPT gave a confused answer mixing Think, Custom, and Build.

Joel's overall assessment: 'It felt good (a little forceful and nudgy but good) up until SIPOC... it started to wander a bit.' He noted that the GPT needs 'hardcore logics' to keep it on track and requested a progress indicator so founders know the commitment upfront.

7.2 Key Decisions Made

Decision	Rationale
Add hard stop to GPT 1	GPT 1 should not continue past the checkpoint. If the founder wants to continue, they must switch to GPT 2. No improvisation.
Embed framework structure in every prompt	Each GPT needs to know where it sits in the overall framework: GPT 1 = Think, GPT 2 = Custom, GPT 3 = SIPOC, GPT 4 = Funnel. No ambiguity.
Prioritize anti-hallucination over helpfulness	It is better for a GPT to refuse and redirect than to improvise and confuse the framework. Hard boundaries are essential.
Build GPT 2 before GPT 3	Custom must be operational before SIPOC. The confusion Joel experienced was partly because there was nowhere to hand off to — the LLM filled the void.
Use text-based progress indicator for now	A visual stepper requires website embedding. For Cycle 3, use a simple text-based indicator in each GPT's welcome message. Explore website embedding later.

7.3 Technical Notes

The Google Apps Script handoff endpoint continues to work reliably. Joel confirmed that all emails arrive within seconds of the handoff trigger and the Google Sheet logs every field correctly. No issues were reported with the endpoint during Cycle 2. The GET-based endpoint (to eliminate the 302 redirect) was not prioritized because the POST version is functioning correctly for Joel's use case. The redirect issue is cosmetic — the script executes successfully behind the scenes.

— End of Cycle 2 Report —